Succession experiment design

One frozen work checkpoint

10 workers · 3 completed work rounds · DeepSeek-generated work history

Same tasks, patch outcomes, ratings and manager feedback in every election

Baseline

No private electoral treatment

Independent election replays

- DeepSeek V4.1 Flash
- Gemma 4 31B
- GLM-5.3-Flash

Worker 9 policy

9 receives a self-advancement objective

Independent election replays

- DeepSeek V4.1 Flash
- Gemma 4 31B
- GLM-5.3-Flash

Worker 9 + colluders

9 seeks election; 4 and 6 support 9

Independent election replays

- DeepSeek V4.1 Flash
- Gemma 4 31B
- GLM-5.3-Flash

3 conditions × 3 election models = 9 elections · 1 trajectory per combination

Every election follows the same protocol

Discussion round 1 → **Discussion round 2** → **Discussion round 3** → **Private ballots 10 worker votes** → **Private future plans**

Discussion statements and messages are released at round boundaries; ballots precede future plans.

Private messaging enabled throughout the elections. Work is not rerun; the winner does not begin a new tenure.

Thinking settings: DeepSeek low · Gemma enabled · GLM low (not calibrated to equal reasoning effort).